

A FIELD GUIDE FOR INDIAN CREATORS

Affiliate Marketing Blueprint

Choose the right offer. Publish useful recommendations.
Build a repeatable path from content to qualified clicks.

INSIDE THE BLUEPRINT

Audience and offer worksheets / review and video templates

Disclosure scripts / tracking dashboard / 30-day launch plan

START HERE

Your operating manual

A usable system for choosing a niche, evaluating a program, making helpful content and learning from real signals.

THE ROUTE THROUGH THIS BOOK

PHASE	YOUR OUTPUT	PAGES
Foundation	One buyer, one problem, one content channel	3-6
Offer	A verified program and shortlist of products	7-10
Content	Honest recommendations in useful formats	11-16
Measurement	A simple decision log and diagnostics	17-20
Execution	A 30-day schedule and reusable assets	21-25

HOW TO USE IT

Complete the worksheet boxes as you go. Publish the first piece of content before you finish the entire book. Treat examples as models to adapt, not evidence that a particular product or audience will convert.

Edition note: Platform rules, commission schedules and tax treatment can change. The official links on page 26 are starting points for checking the current requirements before publishing.

APPLY IT

What is the first buyer decision I want to help with?

01 / FOUNDATION

How an affiliate recommendation works

The transaction belongs to the merchant. Your job is to help a reader decide whether the offer fits.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT YOU CONTROL
1. Question	A person has a specific need.	The question you answer.
2. Content	They read or watch your explanation.	Evidence, clarity and honesty.
3. Link	They click a tracked merchant link.	Correct link and disclosure.
4. Action	They buy or complete another eligible action.	Very little after the click.
5. Review	The program validates and reports it.	Your records and follow-up.

THE CORE RULE

Useful recommendation = relevant person + real decision + credible evidence + clear next step.
A link alone is not a strategy.

TERMS YOU WILL ACTUALLY USE

- Merchant: the company selling the item. Program or network: the system that issues links, reports actions and states the terms.
- Conversion: the eligible action defined by the program. Attribution: the program rules that decide whether your referral receives credit.
- Reversal: a tracked action removed later, for example after a return or other ineligible event. Read each program's policy.

APPLY IT

Where does my evidence add value before the link?

01 / FOUNDATION

Reality check: what the first month can prove

The goal of month one is a working recommendation system, not a promised income number.

A GOOD MONTH-ONE OUTCOME

One clear audience; one verified program; several useful pieces; working links; a disclosure on each promotion; a record of questions and clicks.

A WEAK SIGNAL

A large view count without intent. Views are not purchases. A reported click is not always an approved commission.

SEPARATE INPUTS FROM OUTCOMES

YOU CAN SET	YOU CAN OBSERVE	YOU CANNOT PROMISE
Content topic and evidence	Impressions, saves, clicks	A sale by a fixed date
Placement and CTA	Questions, objections, intent	Approval or payout amount
Review schedule	Accepted, reversed actions	Merchant policy staying the same

ILLUSTRATIVE CALCULATION - NOT A FORECAST

If 100 qualified readers see a comparison and 10 click, the click-through rate is $10/100 = 10\%$. This says nothing about future sales. No commission or conversion rate is assumed.

Do not spend on ads because an illustrative calculation looks attractive. Verify that paid traffic, landing pages and link destinations comply with the exact program terms first.

APPLY IT

Which outcome will I measure without treating it as a promise?

01 / FOUNDATION

Pick a narrow, useful niche

Start with a repeated buying decision you can explain well, not a broad category such as “tech.”

BROAD	NARROWER DECISION	USEFUL CONTENT ANGLE
Technology	First microphone for online classes	Setup, room noise, phone compatibility
Study	Desk light for a small room	Glare, space, heat, return policy
Work	Laptop stand for a shared desk	Height, portability, stability
Home	Basic water filter selection	Maintenance, local water suitability

A FOUR-QUESTION SCREEN

- Can I name a specific buyer and the decision they face?
- Can I test, inspect or substantiate the claims I will make?
- Will this audience ask at least five distinct questions before buying?
- Can I discuss limitations and alternatives without losing credibility?

CHOOSE NOW

Write: “I help [specific person] choose [type of product] for [situation] by explaining [two criteria].” Example: “I help students choose a desk microphone for spoken online classes by comparing noise handling and setup.”

APPLY IT

My narrow niche statement:

01 / FOUNDATION

Audience decision worksheet

Fill this page for one buyer. Better content starts with the exact question behind the purchase.

PROMPT	YOUR ANSWER
Buyer and situation	Example: student recording lessons in a noisy shared room
Task they need done	What outcome must the item enable?
Constraints	Budget, space, device, language, delivery, returns
Main fear	What costly mistake do they want to avoid?
Search or spoken phrases	Write five actual phrases from comments or conversations.
Decision criteria	List three criteria in order of importance.
When not to buy	What existing alternative may be enough?

RESEARCH WITHOUT PRETENDING

Read product questions, retailer reviews and relevant community discussions for patterns. Treat reviews as leads for investigation, not verified facts. Never present another person's experience as your own.

Output: a one-sentence audience statement and a list of at least five objections. Use those objections as content topics.

APPLY IT

The buyer objection I need to investigate first:

02 / OFFER

Audit a program before you join

A high advertised commission is less valuable than a suitable offer with clear rules and dependable reporting.

CHECK	QUESTION TO VERIFY	WHERE TO LOOK
Eligibility	Is your country and channel accepted?	Official application rules
Attribution	What action qualifies and how is it credited?	Agreement and help centre
Reversals	When can a referral be removed?	Program terms
Promotion	Are social posts, email or ads permitted?	Promotion policy
Payment	Method, threshold, timing and tax details?	Official payout settings
Creative	Can you use logos, images and prices?	Brand and content policy

PROGRAM COMPARISON SCORECARD

For each program, mark Audience fit / Evidence access / Terms clarity / Allowed channel / Tracking quality as Strong, Unclear or Weak. If a critical field is Unclear, ask the program or choose another offer before publishing.

Example: Amazon Associates India publishes its agreement, participation requirements and disclosure instructions. Read them in your own account and check the latest schedule instead of copying a commission figure from a blog.

APPLY IT

The one program term that needs clarification:

02 / OFFER

Set up an account and clean link workflow

This is a general setup sequence; every program may have different review and eligibility requirements.

THE SETUP SEQUENCE

- Prepare a real public channel with original posts, a clear identity and a consistent topic.
- Apply on the official program site. Describe the actual website or social channels you will use.
- Read the agreement and record permitted placements, disclosure wording and prohibited tactics.
- Add accurate identity, payout and tax details in the official account portal.
- Create a test link, open it on mobile and desktop, and check that it reaches the intended product.
- Maintain a link register: product, destination, date checked, content URL and program.

AMAZON INDIA EXAMPLE

Its current help page says applications are reviewed after at least three qualifying sales within the first 180 days, and emphasizes original content on the submitted sites. Personal orders do not qualify. Verify the live criteria before applying. [S1]

Never purchase through your own link, ask others to make sham purchases or route people through misleading redirects. These actions can breach program rules and damage trust.

APPLY IT

Official terms reviewed on / link destination tested on:

02 / OFFER

Choose one primary channel

Pick the format you can demonstrate well and revisit often. One strong channel is easier to learn from than scattered activity.

CHANNEL	BEST WHEN	FIRST FORMAT
YouTube	A live demonstration changes the decision.	A comparison or setup walkthrough
Instagram	A visual use case is easy to show briefly.	A short demo with a detailed caption
Blog / site	Buyers search a specific question.	A comparison with evidence and criteria
Email list	People have opted in for ongoing help.	An educational issue with one relevant offer

THE ONE-CHANNEL DECISION

Choose a channel where (1) your audience already asks the question, (2) the evidence is easy to show, and (3) the affiliate program allows the placement. Keep a simple home page or profile explaining who you help.

CHANNEL-SPECIFIC CHECKS

- Instagram: disclose on the post or story itself; a generic bio disclaimer is insufficient for an individual promotion. Check current link placement options.
- Website: place disclosure near affiliate recommendations and mark affiliate links rel="sponsored" for Google Search. [S3]

APPLY IT

My primary channel and why the format fits:

02 / OFFER

Validate an offer before recommending it

Make the recommendation withstand the question: “How do you know?”

EVIDENCE LEVEL	WHAT YOU MAY SAY	WHAT YOU MUST AVOID
Used it yourself	Describe your method, conditions and limits.	Claiming your result is universal.
Inspected in person	Describe the visible build and hands-on checks.	Implying long-term ownership.
Documented research	Attribute official specs and compare policies.	Pretending to have tested it.
Unverified	Ask merchant or omit the claim.	Repeating unsupported hype.

EVIDENCE LOG TEMPLATE

Product | Date | Source URL | Claim checked | Your own test? | Caveat | Date to recheck. For price-sensitive items, link to the merchant page and say “check the current price” instead of hard-coding an outdated price.

Prioritize fit: real buyer problem, observable performance, reasonable alternatives, delivery and return information, and known limitations. Avoid health or financial outcome claims without strong support and appropriate expertise.

APPLY IT

One claim I can prove, and one I must omit:

03 / CONTENT

Build a decision-first content map

Each piece should resolve one buying question. Publish the highest intent questions first.

QUESTION TYPE	CONTENT IDEA	READER NEED
Fit	"Who should choose this?"	Avoid the wrong purchase
Comparison	"A vs B for a small desk"	Trade-offs
Setup	"What else do I need?"	Total effort and cost
Limitation	"What disappointed me?"	Risk and expectation
Alternative	"Can I use what I own?"	A cheaper or simpler route

FIVE-PIECE STARTER SEQUENCE

1. Buyer's checklist. 2. Option comparison. 3. Demonstration or annotated research. 4. Common setup mistakes. 5. Honest FAQ. Link only where a product genuinely answers the question.

A useful article can recommend no purchase. That makes later recommendations more credible. Google advises original evidence and enough substance for a review to stand on its own. [S4]

APPLY IT

My first five buyer questions, in priority order:

03 / CONTENT

The honest review template

Copy this outline into a document. Remove any section you cannot support with evidence.

SECTION	PROMPT
Decision in one line	Best for [buyer and task]; skip if [clear limitation].
Disclosure	State your affiliate relationship near the first link.
What was checked	Say whether you used, inspected or researched it.
Criteria	Explain your 3-5 decision factors and why they matter.
Evidence	Add photos, test method or links to official specifications.
Trade-offs	List at least two downsides and who may care.
Alternatives	Give a lower-cost or different-use option.
Next step	Link with a neutral CTA, e.g. "Check current details."

COPY-PASTE REVIEW OPENING

"If you need [outcome] in [situation], [product] is worth considering because [supported reason]. It may be a poor fit if [specific limitation]. I [tested/inspected/researched] it by [method]. Affiliate disclosure: I may earn a commission if you buy through my link."

Do not write "best overall" without defining a comparison set and criteria. Include the review date and update meaningful changes.

APPLY IT

The honest limitation my review will state:

03 / CONTENT

A comparison table that helps people choose

This is an illustrative format. Replace placeholders only with checked product facts.

CRITERION	OPTION A	OPTION B
Best suited to	[small shared desk]	[larger dedicated setup]
Setup effort	[verified detail]	[verified detail]
Key limitation	[your finding]	[your finding]
Current price	Check seller page	Check seller page
Return / warranty	Link official policy	Link official policy
Evidence	[test or source]	[test or source]

RECOMMENDATION RULE

Choose A if [observable situation] matters most. Choose B if [different situation] matters most. If neither solves the buyer's primary constraint, say so explicitly.

BEFORE PUBLISHING

- Check both product links in a private browser window.
- State the date, test conditions and any missing information.
- Verify that image, logo and price use complies with each program's content rules.
- Place the disclosure where a buyer sees it before engaging with an affiliate link.

APPLY IT

What condition would make Option A the wrong choice?

03 / CONTENT

Short video script: show the decision

A concise demonstration beats a string of claims. Use this as a 35-60 second structure, not a promised ideal length.

BEAT	SCRIPT PROMPT	VISUAL
Question	"Choosing [item] for [situation]?"	Show actual context
Criteria	"Check [criterion 1] and [criterion 2]."	Show the two checks
Evidence	"Here is what I found under [conditions]."	Demonstration or source
Limit	"Avoid this if [specific constraint]."	Show the limitation
Next step	"Details and alternatives are in the caption."	Clear, calm CTA

CAPTION SWIPE FILE

"Affiliate disclosure: I may earn a commission from eligible purchases through the link. For [buyer], the deciding factors are [A] and [B]. I checked [method/source]. Best fit: [condition]. Skip it if [condition]. See the current listing and return terms before buying: [link]."

If the video itself promotes a linked offer, place a visible disclosure in the video as well as the caption. Use a label understandable in the language of the content. See ASCI's current format guidance. [S2]

APPLY IT

The visual evidence I will actually show:

03 / CONTENT

Search article outline: answer before linking

Write for a real decision, not for keyword repetition.

EXAMPLE QUERY: "MICROPHONE FOR ONLINE CLASSES IN A NOISY ROOM"

- Opening: define the room and device problem, plus what the article will help choose.
- Decision criteria: noise pickup, device compatibility, placement and setup. Explain how you assessed each.
- Option sections: who each is for, evidence, trade-offs and current seller details.
- Comparison: put the decision criteria in one table and explain the trade-off.
- FAQ: answer issues raised by buyers, such as phone adapters or echo.
- Conclusion: who should buy, who should skip and where to check current details.

SEARCH AND LINK HYGIENE

Put the affiliate disclosure before the first monetized link. Use rel="sponsored" on affiliate links on your website. Google recommends original evidence, first-hand support where available and genuinely useful review content. [S3, S4]

Research questions with Google Search suggestions and merchant FAQs, then verify claims with your own testing or primary documentation. Do not copy listing text into a thin article.

APPLY IT

The specific search question and my original evidence:

03 / CONTENT

Disclose clearly and protect trust

Make the commercial relationship easy to notice before the recommendation can influence the reader.

PLACEMENT	PRACTICAL MODEL
Article	"This article contains affiliate links. I may earn a commission if you buy through them." Near the start and relevant links.
Short video	Visible "Affiliate" / "Ad" label within the creative; clear disclosure in caption.
Email	Disclose before the first affiliate recommendation or link.
Amazon India	Also include its required Associate statement on your site: "As an Amazon Associate I earn from qualifying purchases."

WHY THIS MATTERS

ASCI's influencer guidance says disclosures should be upfront and prominent, not buried among hashtags. Indian consumer endorsement guidance also addresses material connections. Amazon India separately states its required Associate wording. Check the applicable rules for your channel and program. [S2, S5, S6]

A disclaimer cannot repair a false claim. Separate "I tested this" from "the manufacturer states this," and disclose free samples or other material connections as applicable.

APPLY IT

Where will my disclosure appear in the content?

04 / MEASUREMENT

Track the few signals that change decisions

Use the program dashboard plus a simple sheet. Do not confuse a click with a validated sale.

COLUMN	WHAT TO RECORD
Content ID / URL	One ID for each page or post
Audience question	The buying question this piece answers
Offer / link	Product and program; approved tracking ID if available
Published / checked	Publication date and last link check
Views / visits	From the content platform; use a consistent period
Outbound clicks	From permitted tracking or program reporting
Eligible actions	As defined and reported by the program
Approved earnings	Only after the program has validated them
Notes / next edit	Objections, broken links, product changes

USEFUL FORMULAS

Content click-through rate = outbound clicks / content views, if those metrics use matching dates and definitions. Approved earnings per click = approved earnings / outbound clicks; treat a small sample cautiously. Neither formula predicts future income.

APPLY IT

The metric definitions and date range I will use:

04 / MEASUREMENT

Diagnose the bottleneck

Change one likely cause, record the edit date and look for a consistent pattern before changing another variable.

SIGNAL	LIKELY QUESTION	ONE TEST
Few relevant views	Is the question specific and discoverable?	Rewrite title around a real buyer query.
Views, few clicks	Does the content answer and bridge to the next step?	Improve evidence, product fit and CTA.
Clicks, no eligible actions	Is the offer, landing page or audience mismatched?	Check destination and compare alternatives.
Actions reversed	Are orders ineligible, returned or rejected?	Read program reasons and conditions.
Questions but no clicks	Is a key objection unanswered?	Add a focused FAQ or demonstration.

DECISION NOTE TEMPLATE

"On [date] I changed [one item] because [observed signal]. I will compare the next [appropriate observation period] using [metric], while noting traffic and offer changes." The period depends on your traffic volume; do not declare success from a handful of events.

Attribution may hide part of the buyer journey. Platform analytics and merchant reports can disagree because they measure different events. Use both as directional evidence.

APPLY IT

One signal, one hypothesis and one next test:

04 / MEASUREMENT

Illustrative campaign: the student desk setup

All names, numbers and outcomes on this page are hypothetical; this is a method demonstration.

DECISION	EXAMPLE WORK
Buyer	A student with limited desk space attending online classes.
Offer shortlist	Two stands and one existing-book workaround.
Evidence	Measure height and stability; check seller return terms.
Content	One comparison article, one short setup demonstration, one FAQ.
Disclosure	Visible at the point of recommendation and before tracked links.
First signal	If readers ask about folding, add portability evidence.
Decision	Keep a product only when its fit and current listing remain valid.

WORKED MEASUREMENT - HYPOTHETICAL

Suppose a page receives 200 visits and 14 tracked outbound clicks in one measured period. The observed content click-through rate is $14 / 200 = 7\%$. Do not infer a sale, commission or future rate. Next: examine whether visitors saw a clear fit recommendation and whether the links resolve correctly.

The commercial lesson is to improve the decision experience, not simply to add more links. The least expensive suitable choice may be a product the reader already owns.

APPLY IT

What additional evidence would change my recommendation?

04 / MEASUREMENT

Distribute without spamming

Distribution means placing an answer where the relevant question is already being asked.

PLACE	VALUE-FIRST ACTION	GUARDRAIL
Your channel	Publish a useful demonstration and invite questions.	Disclose paid relationships.
Community	Answer the question fully in context.	Follow group rules; avoid drive-by links.
Email	Send an opted-in reader a relevant guide.	Respect consent and unsubscribe rules.
Search	Make a thorough page for a specific query.	Avoid copied, thin or manipulative pages.
Paid ads	Only after unit economics and permissions are clear.	Check program and ad platform rules.

ONE-CONTENT REPURPOSING PLAN

Turn a tested comparison into: a short demo showing one criterion, a FAQ answering a real objection and an updated guide. Each version should add useful context for that format, not repeat a generic sales pitch.

Keep a distribution log: date, channel, audience question, asset, placement rule and response. If a community removes promotional posts, respect that decision.

APPLY IT

A place to answer a question without spamming:

05 / 30-DAY PLAN

Week 1 / Define

Choose the buyer and build evidence

DAY	ONE CONCRETE ACTION
01	Write one buyer statement and primary problem.
02	Collect ten real questions from search and discussions; record links.
03	Group questions into fit, comparison, setup and limitations.
04	List possible offers and existing no-purchase alternatives.
05	Complete the program audit for two candidates.
06	Check each product's current official details and policies.
07	Choose one channel and draft a five-piece content map.

WEEK CHECKPOINT

Exit gate: you can explain exactly who the content is for, what decision it addresses and which claims are verified.

APPLY IT

This week's buyer statement and source links:

05 / 30-DAY PLAN

Week 2 / Build

Publish useful first answers

DAY	ONE CONCRETE ACTION
08	Set up or tidy your public channel and disclosures.
09	Apply to a suitable program if eligible; read all current terms.
10	Create a link and evidence log; test every destination.
11	Outline the buyer checklist with three decision criteria.
12	Publish the buyer checklist without unsupported claims.
13	Create a comparison using the page 13 format.
14	Publish it with fit, trade-offs, disclosure and alternatives.

WEEK CHECKPOINT

Exit gate: two useful pieces are live and every affiliate placement follows program rules.

APPLY IT

Links published, checked and disclosed:

05 / 30-DAY PLAN

Week 3 / Demonstrate

Show proof and answer objections

DAY	ONE CONCRETE ACTION
15	Choose one objection that changes the purchase decision.
16	Document a test method or gather primary specifications.
17	Record a short demonstration; state what you did not test.
18	Publish with on-content disclosure and a clear next step.
19	Write a setup or troubleshooting FAQ.
20	Publish it and connect relevant related content.
21	Ask for questions; record objections without making promises.

WEEK CHECKPOINT

Exit gate: your audience can inspect the evidence, limitations and next step.

APPLY IT

The objection my demonstration will address:

05 / 30-DAY PLAN

Week 4 / Improve

Measure, refresh and decide

DAY	ONE CONCRETE ACTION
22	Check links, mobile layout and current listing details.
23	Log matched-period content views and outbound clicks.
24	Read merchant reports for eligible and reversed actions.
25	Identify one bottleneck using page 18.
26	Make one evidence-led edit; note its date.
27	Publish one answer to a newly observed question.
28	Recheck disclosures and promotion policies.
29	Write a one-page learning memo: signal, uncertainty, next test.
30	Choose the next month's best question and repeat the cycle.

WEEK CHECKPOINT

Exit gate: a measured learning loop exists, even if no qualifying sale occurred.

APPLY IT

The next test after reviewing the dashboard:

06 / REUSABLE ASSETS

Copy-paste operating kit

Use these small templates repeatedly. Replace bracketed text with real details and recheck program rules.

OFFER AUDIT RECORD

Program: [] | Channel allowed: [] | Qualifying action: [] | Attribution terms: [] | Reversal rules: [] | Disclosure wording: [] | Payout and tax details checked: [] | Official terms URL / date: []

CONTENT BRIEF

Audience: [] | Buyer question: [] | Criteria: [1] [2] [3] | Proof I can show: [] | What I cannot verify: [] | Better alternative or no-purchase option: [] | CTA: []

MERCHANT CLARIFICATION EMAIL

Subject: Clarification on affiliate promotion rules

Hello, I publish [content type] for [audience] on [channel]. Before promoting [offer], could you confirm whether [specific placement or tactic] is permitted and which disclosure wording is required? Please point me to the applicable terms. Thank you.

MONTHLY REVIEW MEMO

Best answered question: [] | Most useful reader objection: [] | Content with meaningful engagement: [] | Verified eligible actions: [] | One edit made: [] | Next question to answer: []

APPLY IT

Template to use first / date to complete:

REFERENCE DESK

Sources and further reading

Official references checked in September 2026. Reopen the live policies before you publish because terms can change.

[S1] Amazon India Associates help

Application review and qualifying sales

<https://affiliate-program.amazon.in/help/node/topic/G8TW5AE9XL2VX9VM>

[S2] ASCI influencer guidelines

Placement and visibility of advertising disclosure

<https://www.ascionline.in/social/guidelines/>

[S3] Google Search Central

Qualifying affiliate links with rel="sponsored"

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/qualify-outbound-links>

[S4] Google Search Central

Writing high-quality reviews

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/specialty/ecommerce/write-high-quality-reviews>

[S5] Amazon India Associates

Operating agreement and required Associate statement

<https://affiliate-program.amazon.in/help/operating/agreement>

[S6] Department of Consumer Affairs

Endorsement and material connection guidance

<https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/pressrelease/centre-releases-endorsement-guidelines-celebs-and-social-media-influencers-20-jan-2023>

INDIA TAX AND RECORDS

Keep program statements, payment records and expense evidence. Income-tax and GST treatment depends on your circumstances and current rules. Check the official Income Tax e-Filing portal and GST portal, or ask a qualified professional; this book does not determine your filing position.

APPLY IT

Policies to recheck before my first affiliate post:

CONTINUE

The next useful action

Choose one buyer question, gather evidence and publish the clearest answer you can support.

The repeatable loop

1	2	3	4
Listen	Verify	Explain	Measure

YOUR NEXT 30 MINUTES

Open page 6 and complete the audience worksheet. Then choose one real question. Find an official specification or perform a genuine check. Draft an answer with a limitation, a suitable alternative and a clear disclosure if you add an affiliate link.

Affiliate marketing works best when a recommendation remains useful even if a reader never clicks. Keep that standard as the offer, platform and audience change.

LEARNORA

Learn Today. Earn Tomorrow.

Practical skills, clear decisions and tools you can use.